

VER. 26.4.1

Rules

Buhurt

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1. General Provisions

1.1. Criteria for Participation

Competitors must be of legal age in their country and the tournament hosting country.

Declare they are medically fit to fight prior to participation in the fight.

A competitor must sign the disclaimer document (which states that the fighter is aware of the risks associated with participation and acknowledges that the organizer provides no warranties, that they have read the rules and agree to comply).

1.2. Scoring System Overview

The grounded position of all the opposing team fighters is the main victory criteria in group battles.

1.3. Grounding Competitor

1.3.1. Cases for Grounding

The competitor is grounded in the following cases:

- **They touched the ground** with torso, hip, arm, hand, knee, shield except with their two feet.
- **They touched a grounded fighter** for support with downward pressure.
- If the list has no bottom rail touching the ground, and they fell or stepped with both feet completely **out/under the list**. Marshals visually determine the boundary of the list.
- **Armour failure**: if an element of the equipment cannot perform its protective function or is lost, the fighter shall be grounded by marshals. This includes helmet, neck protection (gorget), torso protection (a brigandine, a breastplate, etc), shoulder, elbow, forearm defense, gauntlet, groin protection, shin, thigh, a sabaton, knee-cop, upper arm defense.
- While not carrying a weapon in their hand, they **engaged in offensive actions** like striking, pushing, grappling, or tripping, directed at an opponent. Holding a shield is not considered holding a weapon.
- **They took a reserve weapon** from a squire beyond an allocated weapon distribution zone, or inside of the fenced list area, or, if the list has a wide top bar, collected it in any way other than picking it up from the surface of the bar in the allocated area.
- If the list is a wide top bar, they had their **full body and legs on top of the list**.
- **They were grounded by a marshal** as a result of the rules violation.
- **They yielded** by kneeling, voluntarily withdrawing from a fight.

1.3.2. Cases for not Grounding

The competitor is not grounded in the following cases:

- They touched the ground **during or immediately after a successful takedown** with one of the following cases:
  - Edge of their shield (not a flat part),
  - Hand (open hand),
  - Fist (closed hand) .
- They touched their immediate opponent (a fighter they are grappling/falling together with) with any point of contact except for their torso, hips, or buttocks **immediately after a successful throw**.
- If the remaining protective elements can **compensate for an armor failure**.

  Example:

  If the armor failure occurs to buttocks protection, cuisses that are supplementing a skirt or back elements of a greave.
- They touched the ground with **any part of a weapon**.

2. Authorized Equipment

These rules aim to ensure a high standard of authenticity, safety, and historical accuracy in the equipment and conduct of the participants.

2.1. General Requirements

Reference all **Authenticity Committee documents** for the detailed rules.

2.1.1. Technical and Authentic Compliance

All equipment must meet Buhurt International technical and authentic requirements.
Reference:

- "**Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"** document for the rules.
- "**Technical Requirements for Weapons**" document.
- "**Technical Requirements for Armors**" document.

2.1.2. Competitor Eligibility

Competitors are not allowed unless they have passed technical and authenticity checks.

2.1.3. Weapon Requirements

Reference "**Technical Requirements for Weapons**" document for all the rules.
Reference "**Weapons/Shield Chart"** document for sizes and weights.
Reminder: Low-quality, dirty, rusty, or historically implausible weapons are not allowed.

2.1.4. Footwear

Reference "**Textiles and Leather**" document for details.
Reminder: Only medieval Shoes with low profile (non-lugged/studded/spiked) are allowed.

2.1.5. Materials

Reference "**Textiles and Leather**" document for details.
Reminder: Modern adhesive tape, plastic ties, and other visible modern materials are not permitted.
Textile adhesive tape of neutral colors for kit repair is an exception.

2.1.6. Decorations

Reference "**Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"** for details.
Reminder: Slogans and imagery on equipment should be historically plausible and not derogatory.
No modern equipment or decorations are allowed.

2.2. Specifics on Weapons and Shields

All Buhurt International weapons and shields are permitted.
Any combination of these weapons is allowed.
Reference:

- "**Shields and Bucklers**" document.
- "**Technical Requirements for Weapons**" and specific documents for each weapon type.

2.3. Equipment Changes

Participants are allowed to change elements of equipment (armor or weapon) during the time between rounds and/or matches.

Technical Marshal supervision is required for equipment changes.

2.4. Marshal Authority

The Head Marshal and Authenticity Representative have the authority to demand changes to any element of armor or weapon for safety, aesthetic, or historical accuracy reasons.

3. Authorized Fighting Techniques

3.1. Permitted Strikes

Strikes are permitted with **any part of the weapon, shield, and various body parts** (arms, legs and head).

A competitor can strike with **a free hand** provided they have a weapon in the other hand. That is at the ready and unsheathed.

A competitor can strike an **opponent who has lost their weapon**.

A competitor can strike an **out of balance opponent** before they are grounded.

3.2. Strike Zones

Strikes are allowed to any area not mentioned as a prohibited strike zone *(see Section 5 below).*

3.3. Weapon-Grabbing

Grabbing the opponent's weapon (except the blade) or shield with a free hand is permitted. You may not grab the blade of any weapon.

3.4. Techniques and Moves

Back heels (tripping), wrestling throws, and clinching are allowed.

Any movement in the list, leaning on the barrier of the list, any holds and grips of the barrier of the list.

A competitor can **disarm any opponent** by any authorized action,

A competitor can **take away a weapon from the belt of the opponent**, provided the fighter holds their weapon. The fighter is then allowed to use the opponent's weapon until the end of the round, and then it must be surrendered back to the opponent.

Opposing fighters (who are armed) can **take or knock down reserve weapons** that are placed on a wide top bar list as long as supports are not holding them.

Grappling the base of the skull but not the bottom edge of the helmet is permitted.

3.5. Weapon Loss

A fighter must hold a weapon with at least one hand.

If a fighter is not holding their weapon with a hand, they are considered disarmed and are not authorized to perform any attacking actions until the grip on the weapon is restored.

A fighter who has lost their weapon is allowed to:

- **Protect themself** from the strikes without performing any offensive actions or holds.
- Take a **reserve weapon** they had with them.
- Take a **reserve weapon** from an ungrounded teammate in the list.
- Take a **reserve weapon** from their teammate located in the allocated weapon distribution zone.
- Grab a polearm which **leans against the top rail** of the barrier or its ungrounded teammate's/owner's body. In this case, it is not considered lying on the surface of the list.
- **Yield** by kneeling.

3.6. Reserve Weapons

3.6.1. Wide top bar list

Reserve weapons must be placed on the top of the bar in the designated area for a fighter to pick up themselves. It is prohibited to pass a weapon to the fighter or hold the weapon when a fighter is taking it.

This will impose a penalty (*See section 5 in "Buhurt Regulations" document*).

3.6.2. No wide top bar list

Reserve weapons may be passed to the fighter from above the top rail of the list within the designated area.

It is prohibited to pass a weapon below the top rail of the list. This will impose a penalty (*See section 5 in "Buhurt Regulations" document*)

4. Prohibited Fighting Techniques

Performance of any prohibited technique is a serious rules violation and is penalized with a verbal warning, yellow or red card. The penalty is imposed **regardless of the fighter's intent.**

4.1. Unlisted Techniques

Any actions not listed in section 4 above are prohibited. **Only authorized techniques are permitted**.

4.2. Thrusting Actions

Any thrusting actions with a weapon are prohibited. Threats of a thrusting action are also prohibited.

4.3. Offensive Actions at Prohibited Strike Zones

Any offensive actions that land on prohibited strike zones (*See section 7 below*) are prohibited.

4.4. Actions with Foot, Shin and Knee

Actions with foot, shin, and knee aimed at the knee are prohibited. This includes actions that may cause the knee to hyperextend, such as push kicks to the thigh.

4.5. Grappling and Holds

Grappling and holding with the hand on specific armor elements (aventail, edge of pauldrons, edge of the helmet), pushes on the bottom edge of the helmet and subsequent neck twists are prohibited.

4.6. Armor Tampering

Deliberate attempts to remove any elements of the armor are prohibited.

The fighter committing the offense will be sat down and given a yellow card.

A fighter who deliberately has their armor so it can be easily removed will receive a yellow card for unsportsmanlike conduct.

4.7. Suffocation Techniques

Grips, clamps, suffocation techniques with direct pressure on the front, side and back of the neck (under or on top of the aventail) using any part of the body, equipment, or weapon are prohibited. A poorly fitted helmet does not count as a suffocating technique.

4.8. Specific Strikes

Strikes or punching with the head of a one-handed axe are prohibited if the grip of the hand is less than 30 cm away from the blade.

Strikes with hammerheads are prohibited.

4.9. Dangerous Takedowns

Any takedown that spikes an opponent on their head/neck and suplex (arch throws) variations are prohibited.

4.10. Intentional Passivity

Intentional passivity and stalling of the action (such as an inactive clinch) are prohibited.

An inactive clinch is a clinch situation with the fighters performing weak weapon strikes or no grappling techniques aimed at grounding their opponent for 10 seconds or longer.

The strikes with a fist, knees, or shield, are not considered.

4.11. Joint Locks and Hyperextension

Arm lock and leg lock techniques, and any actions that may cause a limb to hyperextend, are prohibited.

4.12. Striking Grounded competitors

Striking a grounded competitor is prohibited.

4.13. Injuring a competitor

Deliberately injuring the fighter who has lost a defensive element of equipment.

4.14. Uncontrolled Strikes

Any uncontrolled strikes and actions with a weapon.

4.15. Weapon Loss

It is prohibited to pick up a weapon that is lying flat on the ground, to receive a weapon from an already grounded fighter, to receive a weapon from any area outside the list except for the designated area.

5. Other Prohibited Actions

These rules contribute to maintaining the integrity, safety, and orderliness of the event. They cover aspects such as participant behavior, substance use, adherence to commands, and respect for officials and other attendees. The role of the Knight Marshal is highlighted in several instances, emphasizing their authority and responsibility in ensuring the proper conduct of the event.

5.1. Leaving Lists

Intentional leaving of the lists after the command “Start Fight” and before the announcement of the results of the fight is prohibited. Permission to leave must be granted by the Knight Marshal.

5.2. Interference from grounded competitors

Grounded fighters:

- must **remain on the ground until the “All Rise”** command of the Knight Marshal. They are not allowed to return to a standing position,
- are **not allowed to physically interfere** in the course of the fight,
- must **maintain a comfortable seated or lying position** until the end of the round. A comfortable position is a signal that the fighter is not injured,
- are **not allowed to change their position** in the list unless there is a threat to their safety.

5.3. Equipment and Weapon Approval

Competitors are not allowed to use any part of the equipment or any weapon that hasn't been allowed by the Authenticity Committee.

5.4. Substance Use

It's not allowed for the competitor to be under the influence of alcohol or any psychoactive substances.

5.5. Offensive Actions Against Others

Any offensive actions against marshals, corner support, spectators, or anyone else other than the current opponent are prohibited.

5.6. Event Interference

Any actions made by a competitor or their support that may impede the course of the event are prohibited.

For a demonstration of poor sportsmanship, derogatory behavior, obscene language, commentaries directed at marshals, opponents, or spectators.

6. Prohibited Strike Zones

These rules are designed to prioritize the safety of the participants by prohibiting strikes to vulnerable and potentially dangerous areas. The specific definitions and considerations for the base of the skull and back of the knee provide clarity on the prohibited strike zones. Striking the foot is allowed under certain circumstances, emphasizing the importance of situational awareness and control during combat. The overall intention is to prevent serious injuries and ensure a fair and safe competition.

6.1. Back and Front of the Neck

Strikes to the back and front of the neck are prohibited.

6.2. Base of the Skull

The base of the skull is considered a prohibited strike zone, specifically defined as the bottom third of the back of the helmet.

6.3. Back of the Knee

Strikes to the back of the knee are prohibited. No pressure is to be placed on the back of the knee.

6.4. Groin and Crotch

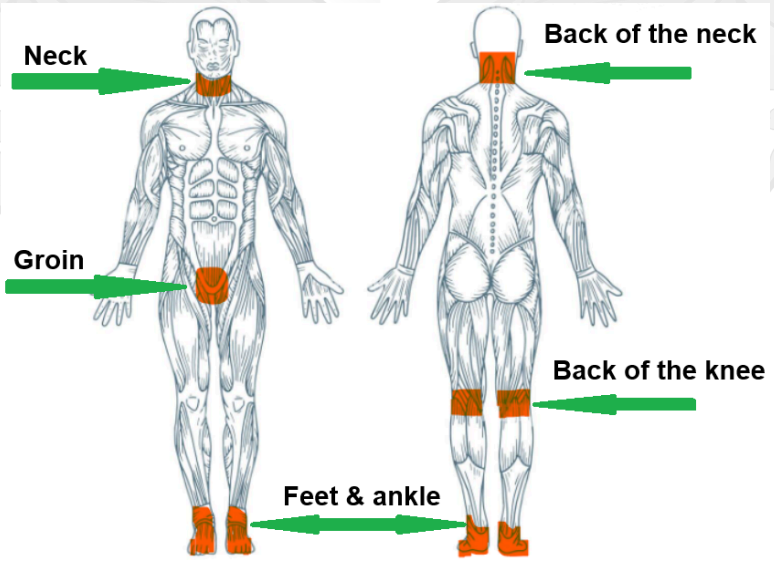
Strikes to the groin and crotch are prohibited.

6.5. Feet and Ankle

Strikes to the feet and ankles are prohibited. However, striking the foot is not considered a prohibited strike if the competitor raises their foot while the strike is already occurring.

6.6. Unprotected Body Parts

Any part of the opponent's body that has lost its protection is considered a prohibited strike zone.



7. Management of the Fights

Fights of the category are managed under the Buhurt International ‘Buhurt Regulations’ by penalties that are imposed depending on the situation in the list and fighters’ and marshals’ actions.

8. Changelog

This will be the change log of this document. It will be updated regularly and will display what has been removed/added/reworded/formatted. This way BI keeps transparent communication and clarity about the rules.

April - 2026 (V. 26.4.1)
Suppression:
- 3.5. Weapon Loss: “Grab a weapon left on the table top by an active fighter.”

April - 2026 (V. 26.4)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Grammatical corrections were also made.
Clarification:
- Section 2. Marshal Structure removed and added to Buhurt Regulations
- Titles for 1.3.1. “Cases For Grounding” and 1.3.2. “Cases for Not Grounding”. No content changes except:
  - “While not carrying a weapon in your hand you're not allowed to engage in offensive actions [...]” to “While not carrying a weapon in their hand, they engaged in offensive actions [...]”
  - “Any part of a polearm, a sword blade or mace is not considered as contacting the ground.” yo “They touched the ground with any part of a weapon”.

Add:
- 3.”Authorized Equipement”: Multiple references to AC documents for details.
- 4.3. Weapon-Grabbing: “Grabbing your own blade by the hand is not allowed.”
- 4.5. Weapon Loss: “Grab a weapon left on the table top by an active fighter.”

Clarification:
- 6.4.2. No “wide” top bar list
- 4. Authorized Fighting Techniques: Introduction paragraph moved to 4.5. Weapon Loss section.

Update: January-2026

-replaced: Various capitalization replacements throughout.

-add: 1.3.1 Added heading.

-add: 1.3.2 Added heading.

-add: 2.1 Shall stop rounds with the “Hold” command and yellow flag between helmets of the fighters. The fighters must stop across the entire list and should not move.

-clarification: 3.1.4 Medieval Shoes with low profile(non lugged/studded/spiked) soles as referenced in Authenticity Standards

-add: 4.1 That is at the ready and unsheathed.

-clarification: 5.3 Any offensive actions that land on prohibited strike zones (See section: 7. Prohibited Strike Zones) are prohibited.

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Update: December-2024

-replaced: “Oral” with “Verbal”

-add: 4.6.2 : This will impose a penalty (See article 5 in “Buhurt Regulations”)

-add: 4.6.1 : This will impose a penalty (See article 5 in “Buhurt Regulations”)

-add: 3.1 Reference ”**Weapons requirements**” for all the rules
-add: 3.1 Reference “**Weapons/Shield Chart”** for sizes and weights

Update date: March-2024

- format: new design format, document will be used from now on.